

CABO VERDE

Translating ambition into results under Ambition 2030: growth, governance and resilience.

This is a draft document prepared for consultation and review. The content is subject to revision and should not be cited or circulated as a final version.

1. Six themes driving Cabo Verde's review

SDG 4 · Quality Education

4 Human Capital & Demographic Dividend

In its third demographic transition, Cabo Verde needs a new population policy that values human capital to sustain productivity gains.

SDG 6 · Clean Water & Sanitation

6 Near-Universal Water Access

Cabo Verde is close to universal access to potable water (94.8%) and sanitation, though irrigation efficiency remains low.

SDG 8 · Decent Work & Economic Growth

8 Strong, Shared Growth

Average annual growth of 8.4% (2021–2025) reduced unemployment, absolute poverty and regional asymmetries, expanding shared prosperity.

SDG 13 · Climate Action

13 Rising Climate Pressure

Prolonged droughts, saltwater intrusion and external shocks threaten water and sanitation, requiring investment in wastewater treatment and reuse.

SDG 16 · Peace, Justice & Strong Institutions

16 Focus on Governance

Cabo Verde ranks as Africa's best-governed country (*World Economic Governance 2026*), with solid institutions, rigorous public finance management and high transparency.

SDG 17 · Partnerships for the Goals

17 Fiscal Self-Reliance

90% of the State Budget is financed from internal resources, demonstrating growing fiscal resilience, with civil society aligned to Ambition 2030.

2. Theme continuity across review cycles

2021		2026
Sustainable recovery agenda (2021)	SUSTAINED	Ambition 2030 & Shared Prosperity
Recession minus 14.8 % GDP contraction	EVOLVED	8.4% Average GDP Growth (2021–2025)
Gender parity & strong institutions	EVOLVED	Africa's Best-Governed Country According to (<i>World Economic Governance</i>)
Emergency budget & fiscal response	SUSTAINED	90% Budget from Internal Resources
Drought & climate pressure	EVOLVED	94.8% Water Access, Climate Pressure

3. Recurring concepts in the Key Messages

Cabo Verde's review centres on strong growth, top-ranked governance and fiscal self-reliance.
Numbers indicate the frequency of references to the concept in the Key Messages document

